BY ORDER OF THE COMMANDER
SPACE LAUNCH DELTA 45

SPACE LAUNCH DELTA 45
INSTRUCTION 21-105

5 MARCH 2026

Maintenance

CRASH DAMAGED OR DISABLED AIRCRAFT RECOVERY (CDDAR) PROGRAM

COMPLIANCE WITH THIS PUBLICATION IS MANDATORY

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This instruction implements Department of the Air Force Instruction (DAFI) 21-101, *Aircraft and Equipment Maintenance Management*, and Technical Order (TO) 00-80C-1, *Crashed, Damaged, Disabled Aircraft Recovery Manual*. The Crash Damaged or Disabled Aircraft Recovery (CDDAR) program is applicable to all organizations tasked to support recovery operations, to include tenant units, and transient aircraft. These organizations must be prepared to rapidly deploy crash recovery equipment and personnel for crashed, damaged, or disabled aircraft deemed necessary by Space Launch Delta 45 (SLD 45) and other tenant units at Patrick Space Force Base (PSFB) and Cape Canaveral Space Force Station (CCSFS). The Det 2/CC is responsible for developing and implementing a CDDAR capability for Ascension Auxiliary Airfield. Refer recommended changes and questions about this publication to the Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR) using the Department of the Air Force (DAF) Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*; route DAF Forms 847 from the field through the appropriate functional chain of command. Ensure all records generated as a result of processes prescribed in this publication adhere to Air Force Instruction (AFI) 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, and are disposed of in accordance with the Air Force Records Disposition Schedule, which is located in the Air Force Records Information Management System.

SUMMARY OF CHANGES

This publication has been revised and must be completely reviewed. Changes include updates to several paragraphs to include adding paragraphs **1.5.4 and 2.1.2** to provide guidance and clarification in the event of a foreign aircraft mishap and the classifications of each removal condition in order to reopen the airfield. Additionally, clarified the requirements for exercises and training to be conducted.

1. Overview.

1.1. The CDDAR program provides the capability to recover crashed, damage, or disabled aircraft in minimal time and establishes a means of returning the airfield to a mission capable status with three priorities. The first priority focuses on reconstitution of the runway/airfield environment suitable for operational use. Followed by the prevention of secondary damage to the aircraft and the preservation of evidence for mishap or accident investigations in accordance with (IAW) DAFI 91-202, *The Department of the Air Force (DAF) Mishap Prevention Program*, and DAFI 91-204, *Safety Investigations and Reports*.

1.2. In-Flight Emergencies (IFEs) or ground emergencies (GEs) involving aircraft require prompt, coordinated actions from many agencies to prevent unnecessary loss of life, damage to equipment, or interference with other flying operations. IFEs and GEs may occur with little to no warning or indication that a problem exists.

1.3. The SLD 45 CDDAR program establishes procedures for recovering crashed, damaged, or disabled aircraft located on PSFB and CCSFS. Due to the unique organizational structure of SLD 45 (no Maintenance Group, Squadrons, or flying missions), Mission Design Series (MDS)-specific equipment, personnel, and resources are limited in scope and capabilities.

1.4. Active Runways.

1.4.1. PSFB has two active runways (03/21 and 11/29).

1.4.2. CCSFS has one active runway (13/31).

1.5. Units.

1.5.1. Aerospace Support Services Contract (ASSC).

1.5.1.1. PSFB and CCSFS Transient Alert (TA) and Aerospace Ground Equipment (AGE) support services are provided and established per ASSC. TA/AGE ASSC providers have limited capabilities to recover crashed, damaged, or disabled aircraft but will respond to all CDDAR events.

1.5.1.2. The Contract Officer's Representative (COR) who oversees the TA/AGE ASSC are assigned to the 45th Logistics Readiness Squadron (45 LRS) and are the OPRs for this instruction (45 LRS/OSM). Ownership of the TA and AGE ASSC belongs to the 30th Contracting Squadron (30 CONS).

1.5.1.2.1. For any requested actions beyond the scope of response and support roles, please consult with the local TA/AGE CORs, the 30 CONS/PM, or the 30 CONS office for any Performance Work Statement clarifications.

1.5.2. 920th Rescue Wing (920 RQW).

1.5.2.1. 920 RQW is an Air Force Reserve Command (AFRC) tenant unit flying organization stationed at PSFB and consists of C-130s and HH-60s.

1.5.3. Department of State Air Wing (DoS AW).

1.5.3.1. The DoS AW is a tenant unit flying organization stationed at PSFB and consists of rotary-wing aircraft (e.g., UH-60 Blackhawk) and various fixed-wing aircraft.

1.5.4. Foreign Aircraft Mishaps.

1.5.4.1. The SLD 45 will notify the U.S. government agency who sponsored the mission for aircraft removal. The aircraft recovery plan will be developed per their requirements. The recovery plan will need the approval from the SLD 45/CC or designated representative.

1.5.4.2. All SLD 45 CDDAR supporting agencies will respond to emergencies or mishaps as described in this instruction.

1.5.5. The SLD 45 CDDAR program is a combined effort between SLD 45 support agencies, TA/AGE ASSC provider, and tenant and transient unit flying organizations (as applicable). This instruction is mutually recognized by all organizations.

1.5.5.1. SLD 45 support agencies will respond to all tenant and transient unit emergency aircraft and provide assistance, as prescribed in Section 3.3. of this instruction.

1.5.5.2. Due to the unique mission at SLD 45, tenant and transient unit flying organizations will ultimately be responsible for their assigned aircraft and will lead coordination with SLD 45 support agencies to obtain essential equipment, tools, and personnel to the response and recovery of any emergency scenario involving their aircraft.

1.6. This instruction is not all-inclusive and is not intended to replace any detailed guidance directed by airframe specific TOs, other instructions, or regulations. Rather, it serves as a coordination tool to ensure all support agencies are aware of their responsibilities during aircraft emergencies.

2. Roles and Responsibilities.

2.1. SLD 45/CC.

2.1.1. Installation/WG/CCs responsible for active airfields/runways, and flying missions, will implement a CDDAR Program IAW TO 00-80C-1, *Crashed, Damaged, Disabled Aircraft Recovery Manual*. (Reference, DAFI 21-101, *Aircraft and Equipment Maintenance Management*, Paragraph 11.28.1.).

2.1.2. The SLD 45/CC, or designated representative, through consultation with PSFB or CCSFS Airfield Management (45 LRS/OSAB or 45 LRS/OSAM) and the SLD 45 Chief of Safety (SLD 45/SE), notifies the PSFB or CCSFS Emergency Operations Center (EOC) Director, as appropriate, will determine removal conditions as designated below:

2.1.2.1. Emergency. This condition requires immediate runway clearance at the risk of losing life, equipment, and evidence. The runway must be cleared as soon as possible; i.e., mission priority alert missions, In-flight Emergencies, or as directed by the EOC.

2.1.2.2. Urgent. This condition requires runway clearance as soon as practical after completion of rescue, firefighting and explosive ordnance disposal (EOD) operations. The runway will be cleared as soon as practical, unless EOD considerations dictate otherwise, using techniques identified in applicable technical publications. The Incident Commander (IC) will make this determination.

2.1.2.3. Routine. This condition allows sufficient time to use recovery techniques to minimize further damage to aircraft, preserve evidence and preclude exposing personnel or equipment to danger

2.1.2.4. In the event of an Emergency or Urgent removal condition, the Recovery/Investigation Phase may be waived by the SLD 45/CC or designated representative.

2.1.2.5. In the event of a Routine removal condition, sufficient time is allowed to use recovery techniques to minimize further damage to aircraft, preserve evidence and preclude exposing personnel or equipment to danger.

2.1.3. For PSFB Airfield, if an aircraft incident causes both runways to close, it may be necessary to clear the aircraft/wreckage as soon as possible to facilitate the re-opening of at least one runway for operational use. The SLD 45/CC, or designated representative, is the only individual authorized to approve this course of action. This decision will be made upon the recommendation of the 45 LRS/OSA, or designated official.

2.1.4. While all CDDAR events are situational based, CDDAR teams may be limited to method towing for the removal/recovery of tenant/transient aircraft. If a crane or other specialized equipment is needed resources must first be coordinated through the owning units chain of command, followed as appropriate by SLD 45, and/or 45th Contracting Squadron (45 CONS).

2.1.5. The 45 LRS Commander (45 LRS/CC):

2.1.5.1. Will coordinate with the SLD 45/CC, or designated representative, for all operational matters and decisions affecting the handling of aircraft emergencies.

2.1.5.2. Provide on-scene fuel servicing of recovery support equipment (i.e., AGE and heavy equipment) and provide fuel sample/analysis of aircraft fuel.

2.1.6. The 45 LRS/OSM are the OPRs for this instruction and responsible for managing the SLD 45 CDDAR program. 45 LRS/OSM will:

2.1.6.1. Coordinate with the 920 RQW and DoS AW to ensure CDDAR program compliance. 920 RQW and DoS AW are responsible for providing a CDDAR Team Chief, Team Members and MDS-specific equipment as required to support CDDAR operations for 920 RQW and/or DoS AW aircraft.

2.1.6.2. Lead at least one exercise annually. SLD 45, 920 RQW and DoS AW CDDAR teams will participate in annual CDDAR exercises and training events for currency. This exercise may be conducted as a tabletop discussion or hands-on exercise IAW DAFI 21-101 and T. O. 00-80C-1. Do not use operational aircraft for actual aircraft lifts in a training environment. If the unit does not possess training assets suitable for exercises, units demonstrate capability by completing all steps but stopping short of actually lifting an operational aircraft. Note: The actual recovery of an aircraft performed by a unit satisfies the annual requirement when it meets all aspects of a crash recovery exercise.

2.1.6.3. Maintain a Master SLD 45 CDDAR Continuity Book per TO 00-80C-1.

2.2. TA/AGE ASSC will:

2.2.1. Provide 24-hour on-call capability in support of CDDAR and contingency operations with a response time of no more than 1 hour after notification.

2.2.2. Maintain a pickup truck as the primary CDDAR response vehicle. This vehicle is considered a mission essential vehicle and will be allowed to visit all base agencies, as applicable to CDDAR.

2.2.3. Maintain an aircraft tow vehicle, MB-2 or equivalent, and will be equipped with emergency lights and a portable Land Mobile Radio capable of monitoring the Fire, Ramp, and Tower radio frequencies.

2.3. 920 MXG/CC or equivalent will:

2.3.1. Ensure, as a minimum, units with a CDDAR requirement possess sufficient equipment to accomplish recovery of the assigned MDS aircraft.

2.3.1.1. Provide adequate weatherproof storage for all recovery equipment.

2.3.2. Ensure, as a minimum, units with a CDDAR requirement possess sufficient personnel, to include a CDDAR Team Chief, to accomplish recovery of the assigned MDS aircraft. Personnel appointed to CDDAR teams will comply with this instruction and training requirements.

2.3.3. Ensure all applicable units participate in at least one exercise annually with SLD 45.

2.3.4. Coordinate management of CDDAR at the unit level to minimize duplication of resources. A unit CDDAR Continuity book shall be maintained.

2.4. Department of State Air Wing will:

2.4.1. Ensure, as a minimum, units with a CDDAR requirement possess sufficient equipment to accomplish recovery of the assigned MDS aircraft.

2.4.1.1. Provide adequate weatherproof storage for all recovery equipment.

2.4.2. Ensure, as a minimum, units with a CDDAR requirement possess sufficient personnel, to include a CDDAR Team Chief, to accomplish recovery of the assigned MDS aircraft. Personnel appointed to CDDAR teams will comply with this instruction and training requirements.

2.4.3. Ensure all applicable units participate in at least one exercise annually with the SLD45.

2.4.4. Coordinate management of CDDAR at the unit level to minimize duplication of resources. A unit CDDAR Continuity book shall be maintained.

2.5. Incident Commander (IC).

2.5.1. The Senior Fire Official (SFO)/Fire Chief will serve as the IC for all incidents resulting from an aircraft crash, fire, or a declared In-Flight Emergency (IFE).

2.5.2. The IC ensures initial rescue, firefighting, security, and safeing procedures are performed. No one other than the first/emergency responders can enter the mishap area. The mishap scene must be determined safe by the IC prior to any investigation or CDDAR actions. The EOC Director will prepare a formal turnover to the Interim Safety Board/Safety Investigation Board (ISB/SIB) in accordance with the Installation Emergency Management Plan (IEMP).

2.5.2.1. If an Interim Safety Board (ISB) is convened, the IC will continue providing support and services as needed to support ISB functions after chain of custody/authority of the mishap wreckage and related evidence is turned over to the ISB/SIB/AIB. DoS AW will assume authority upon release of the IC and EOC director. DoS AW will extend a seat on the Safety Board to SLD 45 when appointed by the Director of DoS AW.

2.5.3. The incident aircraft and its equipment must not be disturbed or removed unless directed or released by the ISB/SIB/AIB President. Control of the mishap scene/site remains with the IC. Once the site is safe, the ISB/SIB becomes the owner of the mishap evidence at the site, but does not assume control or overall authority for the site. After the scene is safe to enter, and at a time deemed appropriate by the IC, command of the incident aircraft/wreckage may be transferred from the IC to the Impoundment Official/owning unit representative appointed by the Convening Authority.

2.6. Interim Safety Board/Safety Board President (ISB/SIB).

2.6.1. The ISB/SIB is responsible for all activities of the Interim Safety Board. Ensures evidence is preserved and the installation is prepared to provide all necessary support to the Investigating Authority upon arrival. Does not assume the role of IC. Coordinates evidence collection with other ISBs if the mishap aircraft or involved personnel are not from the base of occurrence.

2.6.2. Before the mishap site is declared safe, the ISB/SIB's primary role is to monitor and document actions taken so that the original state of the evidence can be understood by the Investigating Authority. Once the site is safe, the ISB/SIB becomes the owner of the mishap evidence at the site but does not assume control or overall authority for the site. The ISB/SIB should have a member at the mishap site whenever possible.

2.6.3. The ISB/SIB will coordinate with the IC to ensure access to the mishap site is closely controlled.

2.7. Emergency Operations Center (EOC):

2.7.1. The EOC is a single-point location for all Emergency Support Functions (ESFs). The ESFs consists of representatives from each responding agency and will serve as a liaison between the SLD 45/CC, the IC, and the ESFs agency.

2.8. 45th Security Forces Squadron (45 SFS).

2.8.1. 45 SFS will establish a cordoned area and entry control point (ECP) in conjunction with the Fire Chief, Bioenvironmental Office, and IC.

2.8.1.1. The cordon size will be established and adjusted, as the situation warrants.

2.8.1.2. The IC will ensure initial cordon dimensions (lateral and vertical), will be passed to the Air Traffic Control (ATC) Tower without delay. Expansions and reductions of the cordon dimensions will be relayed to the ATC Tower without delay.

2.8.1.3. DoS AW Chief of Safety will coordinate with SLD 45's Chief of Safety on procedures related to DoS AW aircraft involved incidents and accidents.

2.9. SLD 45/SE.

2.9.1. Coordinates removal procedures with the CDDAR Team Chief, as required.

2.9.2. Gives guidance for the preservation of evidence for the SIB in accordance with SLD 45 OPLAN 91-204.

2.9.3. Ensures Aviation Safety (SLD 45/SEF) responds as required, to provide SME support.

2.10. The SLD 45 Command Post (SLD 45/CP):

2.10.1. For after-hours emergencies, SLD 45/CP will implement the appropriate checklists and coordinate with the following agencies for CDDAR response/support: SLD 45/CC, the 45th Civil Engineering Squadron (45 CES)/Readiness Flight (CEX), SLD 45/SE, and the 45th Aerospace Medicine Squadron/Bioenvironmental Engineering (45 AMS/SGXB).

2.11. 45th Operational Medical Readiness Squadron (45 OMRS).

2.11.1. Will assist the IC and be available for medical consultation and evaluation of CDDAR personnel in case of ill effects of composite exposure or any other hazards.

2.11.2. Bioenvironmental Engineering (45 OMRS/SGXB).

2.11.2.1. The Bioenvironmental Engineering (BE) office will be consulted in determining personnel health hazards, training required, and appropriate levels of Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) for anticipated responses. Not every scenario can be accounted for, but BE will help determine the most appropriate PPE, which will most likely suit the needs of CDDAR responders.

2.11.2.2. Approve specific type(s) of respirator used, maintained, and stored for the composite recovery team members and provide initial supervisor respirator training and fit tests to all recovery personnel as required.

3. General Sequence of Events.

3.1. Declaration of Emergency.

3.1.1. An emergency is declared by any of the following: The pilot, ATC, officials responsible for the operation of the aircraft, and/or a system-generated transmission from an aircraft.

3.2. Notification.

3.2.1. Following the emergency declaration, 45 LRS/OSAT will activate the Primary Crash Alerting System (PCAS) and notify first/emergency responders.

3.2.2. Upon PCAS notification, PSFB or CCSFS Airfield Management (45 LRS/OSAB or 45 LRS/OSAM) will immediately activate the Secondary Crash Net (SCN) to facilitate the rapid response of key base agencies.

3.2.2.1. During after hours, SLD 45/CP can activate the SCN to contact response agencies and inform them of the emergency.

3.2.3. Following notification, the SFO will assume the role of the IC until one can be appointed if deemed necessary.

3.2.4. First responders will proceed to the emergency aircraft location IAW SLD 45 IEMP 10-2. This will initiate the Response Phase of the plan.

3.2.4.1. If aircraft location is on the airfield/Controlled Movement Area, procedures in DAFI 13-213, *Airfield Driving*, and local directives" must be adhered to.

3.3. Response Phase.

3.3.1. The SFO/IC will decide which first/emergency responders may proceed to ensure the safety of responding personnel, aircrew, and equipment.

3.3.1.1. 45 CES/CEF will extinguish/prevent aircraft fires, ensure the aircraft is safe for other support agencies to approach, and evacuate aircrew, as required. In the event of hazardous material/spill, 45 CES will determine the appropriate cleaning actions and direct support agencies as appropriate. Personnel responding on CCSFS are under the Fire and Emergency Services Contract.

3.3.1.2. 45 SFS, as directed by the SFO/IC, will establish a designated perimeter and an ECP.

3.3.1.3. 45th Medical Group (45 MDG) will provide medical services to first/emergency responders and aircrew, as required.

3.3.1.3.1. 45 MDG personnel will remain outside the designated perimeter. 45 CES/CEF will transport personnel requiring medical attention through the ECP to 45 MDG personnel.

3.3.2. All non-essential vehicles will position themselves not to impede movement or vision and will remain clear of the emergency aircraft. If necessary, the SFO/IC will direct 45 SFS to clear the area of non-essential personnel.

3.3.2.1. This does not prohibit essential vehicles (i.e., tow vehicles) from positioning themselves nearby for immediate use.

3.3.3. The unit owning the aircraft will work through their designated representatives, through the EOC, to advise the SFO/IC of any special considerations, such as classified materials/equipment and/or hazardous cargo on board. These items will need to be identified, accounted for, and recovered prior to any recovery actions. The owning unit, through the EOC, will also provide information on any special recovery requirements for these items.

3.3.3.1. 45 LRS/OSA may also have information on whether or not the emergency aircraft contained classified and/or hazardous cargo.

3.3.4. When first/emergency responder actions have been completed and the emergency aircraft has been declared as "Fire Safe" by the SFO/IC, the Response Phase will end, and the Recovery Phase, including investigation actions, will begin.

3.4. Recovery Phase.

3.4.1. The SFO will transfer control of the emergency aircraft over to the newly appointed IC. If a newly appointed IC is deemed unnecessary, control will transfer to the Interim Safety Board President (ISBP) or Safety Board President (SBP) for investigation.

3.4.2. The EOC Director with approval from the SLD 45/CC or designated representative will activate the Recovery Working Group and identify a Recovery Operations Chief. The main goal of recovery is to reestablish the installation's mission and return to normal operations.

3.4.3. The SFO/IC, in consultation with 45 LRS/OSA, SLD 45/SE, and the owning organization CDDAR Team Chief, will decide the best removal method.

3.4.4. DoS AW Chief of Safety, in coordination with SLD 45's EOC Director, Chief of Safety and SFO/IC will coordinate the recovery phase of the emergency aircraft.

4. Off-base Crash Recovery.

4.1. In coordination with the civilian IC, the CDDAR Team Chief, contractors, and the initial response team will visit the site to review the situation to determine equipment requirements prior to dispatching the entire team.

4.2. Under no circumstances will personnel or equipment be dispatched off-base if it jeopardizes the mission of on-base recovery operations unless directed by the SLD 45/CC or designated representative.

BRIAN L. CHATMAN, Colonel, USSF
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Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

DAFI21-101, *Aerospace and Equipment Maintenance Management*, 20 December 2023

AFI 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, 23 March 2020

DAFI 91-202, *The Department of the Air Force (DAF) Mishap Prevention Program*, 20 March 2020

DAFI 13-213, *Airfield Driving*, 04 February 2020

DAFI 21-101, *Aircraft and Equipment Maintenance Management*, 20 December 2023

DAFI 91-204, *Safety Investigations and Reports*, 10 Mar 2021

IEMP 10-2, *Installation Emergency Management Plan,* 02 June 2025

TO 00-80C-1, *Crashed, Damaged, Disabled Aircraft Recovery Manual*, 31 July 2024

Prescribed Forms

None

Adopted Forms

DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*

Abbreviations and Acronyms

AFI—Air Force Instruction

AFRC—Air Force Reserve Command

AGE—Aerospace Ground Equipment

ASSC—Aerospace Support Services Contract

ATC—Air Traffic Control

BE—Bioenvironmental Engineering

CCSFS—Cape Canaveral Space Force Station

CDDAR—Crashed, Damaged or Disabled Aircraft Recovery

CONS—Contracting Squadron

COR—Contracting Officer Representative

DAFI—Department of the Air Force Instruction

DoS AW—Department of State Air Wing

ECP—Entry Control Point

EOC—Emergency Operations Center

EOD—Explosive Ordnance Disposal

ESF—Emergency Support Function

GE—Ground Emergency

IAW—In Accordance With

IC—Incident Commander

IEMP—Installation Emergency Management Plan

IFE—In Flight Emergency

ISB—Interim Safety Board

ISBP—Interim Safety Board President

LRS—Logistics Readiness Squadron

MDG—Medical Group

MDS—Mission Design Series

OMRS—Operational Medical Readiness Squadron

OPR—Office of Primary Responsibility

PCAS—Primary Crash Alerting System

PPE—Personal Protective Equipment

PSFB—Patrick Space Force Base

RQW—Rescue Wing

SBP—Safety Board President

SCN—Secondary Crash Net

SFO—Senior Fire Official

SFS—Security Forces Squadron

SIB—Safety Investigation Board

SLD—Space Launch Delta

TA—Transient Alert

TO—Technical Order

Office Symbols

30 CONS/PM—30th Contracting Squadron Program Management

45 AMS/SGXB—45th Aerospace Medicine Squadron/Bioenvironmental Engineering

45 CES/CEF—45th Civil Engineering Squadron, Fire Emergency Services

45 CES/CEX—45th Civil Engineering Squadron, Readiness and Emergency Management

45 LRS/OSA—45th Logistics Readiness Squadron, Airfield Operations

45 LRS/OSAB—45th Logistics Readiness Squadron, Airfield Management Operations PSFB

45 LRS/OSAM—45th Logistics Readiness Squadron, Airfield Management Operations CCSFS

45 LRS/OSAT—45th Logistics Readiness Squadron, Air Traffic Control Tower

45 LRS/OSM—45th Logistics Readiness Squadron Maintenance Flight

45 OMRS/SGXB—45th Operational Medical Readiness Squadron, Bioenvironmental Engineering

920 MXG/CC—920th Maintenance Group Commander

SLD 45/CC—Space Launch Delta 45 Commander

SLD 45/CP—Space Launch Delta 45 Command Post

SLD 45/SE—Space Launch Delta 45, Safety

SLD 45/SEF—Space Launch Delta 45, Flight Safety

Terms

Contracting Officer Representative (COR)—A COR is an individual designated in accordance with Department of Defense Federal Acquisition Regulation Supplement subsection 201.602-2 and authorized in writing by the contracting officer to perform specific technical or administrative functions.

Crashed, Damaged or Disabled Aircraft Recovery (CDDAR)—The ability to move damaged or disabled aircraft using specialized equipment.

Program Manager (PM)—The designated individual with responsibility for and authority to accomplish program objectives for development, production, and sustainment to meet the user's operational needs. The PM shall be accountable for credible cost, schedule, and performance reporting to the Milestone Decision Authority.